Airtribe

Growth Loops Identification - Instagram



Project Brief:

- Imagine you're a PM at Instagram, and you are tasked with growing growth opportunities. The first step is to identify all growth loops in the app.

- Go through the user journey in the app, then identify and document:
    - Growth Loop Type: Viral, Content, Paid
    - The What, Who and Why for each step of each loop

- Your goal is to turn your research & understanding about the growth loops into:
    - Apply findings in Instagram to improve any 1 loop to drive future growth.
    - What will be the Epics for the improved feature, and how will you prioritize them?
        - Make sure to justify with a clear rationale coming from user research and/or product strategy

- Prioritize the Epics using the RICE framework

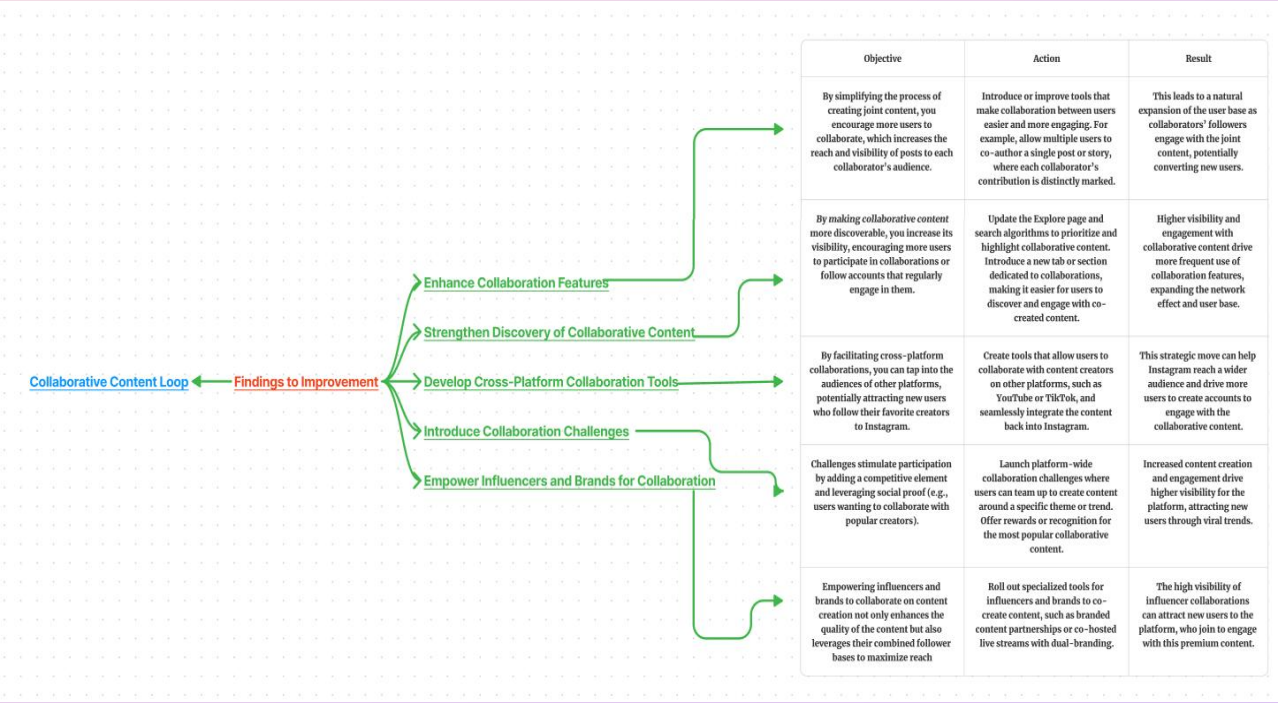
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Growth Loops from User Journey

Sl No	Type of growth loop	What	Who	Why
1	Viral growth Loop	Users share content on other social platforms.	Instagram users and their followers on other platforms.	Attracts new users to Instagram.
2	Content Creation Loop	Users post high-quality content.	Content creators and their followers.	Keeps current users engaged and draws in new users
3	Engagement Loop	Users like, comment, and share posts.	Instagram users and their followers.	Encourages return visits and attracts new users.
4	Discovery Loop	Users explore content via hashtags, explore page, and recommendations.	Instagram users and content creators.	Promotes continuous exploration and engagement.
5	Influencer Loop	Influencers promote Instagram on other platforms or in real life.	Influencers and their followers.	Draws their audience to follow them on Instagram.
6	Paid Advertising Loop	Instagram runs targeted ads.	Advertisers and potential new users.	Encourages new users to sign up and engage with the platform.
7	User-Generated Content Loop	Users create content specific to trending challenges or themes (e.g., memes, viral challenges).	Instagram users participating in trends.	Trend participation creates a buzz that attracts more users to join in and engage, increasing overall platform activity.
8	Collaborative Content Loop	Users collaborate with others to create joint content (e.g., co-hosted stories, shared posts).	Influencers, content creators, and their combined followers and audience.	Collaborations expose each user to the other's audience, driving follower growth and cross-engagement.

9	Social Commerce Loop	Users discover and purchase products directly through Instagram posts and stories.	Instagram users and brands.	The seamless integration of shopping into the platform increases engagement and attracts new users who are interested in social commerce.
10	Event-Driven Loop	Users participate in special events or time-sensitive campaigns (e.g., live streams, limited-time filters	Instagram users drawn to exclusive or time-limited content.	Event-driven interactions generate excitement and FOMO (fear of missing out), bringing more users to the platform during peak times.

Findings to Improve Collaborative content Loop



Objective	Action	Result
By simplifying the process of creating joint content, you encourage more users to collaborate, which increases the reach and visibility of posts to each collaborator's audience.	Introduce or improve tools that make collaboration between users easier and more engaging. For example, allow multiple users to co-author a single post or story, where each collaborator's contribution is distinctly marked.	This leads to a natural expansion of the user base as collaborators' followers engage with the joint content, potentially converting new users.
By making collaborative content more discoverable, you increase its visibility, encouraging more users to participate in collaborations or follow accounts that regularly engage in them.	Update the Explore page and search algorithms to prioritize and highlight collaborative content. Introduce a new tab or section dedicated to collaborations, making it easier for users to discover and engage with co-created content.	Higher visibility and engagement with collaborative content drive more frequent use of collaboration features, expanding the network effect and user base.
By facilitating cross-platform collaborations, you can tap into the audiences of other platforms, potentially attracting new users who follow their favorite creators to Instagram.	Create tools that allow users to collaborate with content creators on other platforms, such as YouTube or TikTok, and seamlessly integrate the content back into Instagram.	This strategic move can help Instagram reach a wider audience and drive more users to create accounts to engage with the collaborative content.
Challenges stimulate participation by adding a competitive element and leveraging social proof (e.g., users wanting to collaborate with popular creators).	Launch platform-wide collaboration challenges where users can team up to create content around a specific theme or trend. Offer rewards or recognition for the most popular collaborative content.	Increased content creation and engagement drive higher visibility for the platform, attracting new users through viral trends.
Empowering influencers and brands to collaborate on content creation not only enhances the quality of the content but also leverages their combined follower bases to maximize reach	Roll out specialized tools for influencers and brands to co-create content, such as branded content partnerships or co-hosted live streams with dual-branding.	The high visibility of influencer collaborations can attract new users to the platform, who join to engage with this premium content.

Epics for Improved Collaborative Content Loop

1. Collaborative Post Creation Tools

- **User Story:** As a user, I want to easily collaborate with others on a single post or story, with clear attribution for each collaborator, so that we can co-create content that reaches both of our audiences.
- **Key Features:**
  - Co-authoring capabilities for posts and stories.
  - Collaboration-specific editing tools.
  - Shared drafts and revision history.
- **Outcome:** Enhanced user collaboration, leading to higher-quality content and broader reach.

2. Collaboration Challenges and Competitions

- **User Story: :** As a user, I want to participate in collaboration challenges with rewards for the best collaborative content, so that I can engage with others and gain recognition.
- **Key Features:**
  - Platform-wide themed collaboration challenges.
  - Reward systems (badges, recognition, prizes).
  - Leaderboards for top collaborations.
- **Outcome:** Increased user engagement and participation, fostering a sense of community and competition.

3. Cross-Platform Collaboration Integration

- **User Story:** As a content creator, I want to collaborate with creators on other platforms and share our joint content on Instagram, so that I can expand my audience across multiple platforms.
- **Key Features:**
  - Tools for integrating content from other platforms (eg. YouTube, TikTok).
  - Simplified sharing and co-posting options.
  - Cross-platform analytics tracking.
- **Outcome:** Broader audience reach and attraction of new users from other platforms.

4. Real-Time Collaboration Features

- **User Story:** As a user, I want to collaborate in real-time with others on live streams and joint content creation, so that we can create dynamic and interactive experiences for our followers.
- **Key Features:**
  - Co-hosted live streams with dual branding.
  - Real-time shared editing tools for stories and posts.
  - Interactive AR effects for joint use.
- **Outcome:** Engaging, spontaneous content that drives immediate user interaction and attracts live viewers.

5. Enhanced Discovery of Collaborative Content

- **User Story:** As a user, I want to easily discover and engage with collaborative content on the Explore page, so that I can find new creators and participate in trending collaborations.
- **Key Features:**
  - New Explore tab or section for collaborative content.
  - Improved search algorithms highlighting collaborations.
  - Recommendation engine prioritizing collaborative trends.
- **Outcome:** Higher visibility for collaborative content, leading to increased user participation and discovery.

6. Gamification of Collaboration

- **User Story:** As a user, I want to earn rewards for successful collaborations and participation in collaborative challenges, so that I am motivated to engage more frequently with others.
- **Key Features:**
  - Badges and rewards for collaborative achievements.
  - Collaboration-specific daily and weekly goals.
  - Progress tracking and milestone celebrations.
- **Outcome:** Sustained engagement through gamified incentives, leading to ongoing content creation and interaction.

7. Analytics and Insights for Collaborators

- **User Story:** As a collaborator, I want access to shared analytics for our joint content, so that we can track our performance and understand how to improve future collaborations.
- **Key Features:**
  - Joint analytics dashboards for co-created posts.
  - Insights into follower engagement and reach.
  - Recommendations for optimizing future collaborations.
- **Outcome:** Data-driven improvements in collaboration quality, leading to more successful content and growth.

RICE Framework :

EPIC	Reach	Imapact	Confidence	Effort	RICE SCore	Priority
Collaborative Post Creation Tools	High	High	High	Medium	8.0	Top
Enhanced Discovery of Collaborative Content	High	Medium-High	High	Low-Medium	7.5	High
Real-Time Collaboration Features	Medium	High	Medium	High	6.0	Medium
Cross-Platform Collaboration Integration	Medium-High	High	Medium	High	5.5	Medium
Collaboration Challenges and Competitions	Medium	Medium-High	Medium	Medium-High	5.5	Medium
Gamification of Collaboration	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	5.0	Medium-Low
Analytics and Insights for Collaborators	Low-Medium	Medium	High	Medium-High	4.5	Low

Prioritization Strategy

1. Prioritize for Impact and Ease of Implementation:

High Impact, Low Complexity (Quick Wins):

- **Collaborative Post Creation Tools:** This is the foundation of the collaborative loop and can have an immediate positive impact on user engagement.
- **Enhanced Discovery of Collaborative Content:** Improving visibility of collaborative content is relatively low in complexity but can significantly boost engagement and attract new users.

High Impact, Higher Complexity:

- **Real-Time Collaboration Features:** Real-time interactions drive significant user engagement and can be prioritized after the foundational tools are in place.
- **Cross-Platform Collaboration Integration:** While more complex, this can tap into broader audiences and bring new users from other platforms.

Lower Impact, Low Complexity:

- **Gamification of Collaboration:** This can be rolled out gradually after the core collaboration tools are in place to further incentivize user engagement.

High Impact, High Complexity:

- **Collaboration Challenges and Competitions:** These can be prioritized after initial tools and discovery features are solidified, driving sustained engagement through structured activities.
- **Analytics and Insights for Collaborators:** Providing data-driven insights is valuable but requires a mature platform with established collaboration features.

2. Build and Measure in Iterative Cycles:

- **MVP (Minimum Viable Product) Approach:** Start with the Collaborative Post Creation Tools and Enhanced Discovery features as a minimum viable product. Measure user engagement and gather feedback.
- **Iterative Enhancements:** Based on user feedback, incrementally roll out the Real-Time Collaboration Features and Gamification to enhance user interaction.
- **Strategic Rollouts:** Introduce the Collaboration Challenges and Cross-Platform Integration in phases to sustain growth, ensuring that each feature is fully adopted before moving on to the next.

3. Align with Business Goals:

- **User Acquisition Focus:** Prioritize features that directly contribute to acquiring new users, such as Cross-Platform Collaboration Integration and Enhanced Discovery.
- **User Retention Focus:** Focus on features that deepen engagement and keep users returning, such as Real-Time Collaboration and Gamification.

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Note : Google and ChatGPT have been utilized for research purposes